

## Ideation Phase

### Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

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|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Date</b>          | 05 September 2026                                  |
| <b>Team ID/SID</b>   | SWUID2026136950                                    |
| <b>Project Name</b>  | Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b> | 4 Marks                                            |

#### Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

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##### Team Gathering

I worked on this project individually. I took on all roles — developer, workflow designer, automation engineer, security analyst, communications lead, reporting analyst, integration specialist, and UX designer. To simulate a real brainstorming session, I represented my own thoughts from eight different perspectives. This helped me explore the problem from every angle and generate a wide range of ideas before narrowing them down.

##### Set the Goal

The goal of this brainstorming session was to identify all possible ways to automate network request management in ServiceNow. I wanted to think broadly — from form design to approval workflows, from task automation to reporting — before deciding what to build.

##### Problem Statement

How might we automate network request management in ServiceNow so that employees receive faster fulfillment, approvals are properly tracked, and the IT team reduces manual effort while maintaining a full audit trail?

#### Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

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##### 8 Perspectives × 6 Ideas Each

##### Person 1 — Developer Perspective

### *Focus: Form and Catalog Design*

1. Create a Service Catalog item for network requests with a standard form
2. Add four required variables: Request Type, Device, Access Level, and Business Justification
3. Use UI Policies to show or hide fields based on request type (Firewall, Access, Configuration)
4. Add validation rules to prevent incomplete submissions
5. Use Service Portal for a user-friendly submission experience
6. Enable attachments for supporting documents like diagrams and approval emails

### **Person 2 — Workflow Designer Perspective**

#### *Focus: Approval Workflow*

1. Build an approval workflow using Flow Designer
2. Send email notifications to approvers when a request is submitted
3. Wait for approval before proceeding to fulfillment
4. Support multi-level approvals for high-risk requests like firewall changes
5. Send reminder emails for pending approvals
6. Escalate overdue approvals automatically to the next level

### **Person 3 — Automation Engineer Perspective**

#### *Focus: Task Automation*

1. Auto-create a Catalog Task after approval
2. Auto-assign the task to the Network Team
3. Set the task state to Open by default
4. Link the task to the Requested Item as its parent
5. Wait for task completion before closing the request
6. Auto-close the Requested Item when the task is marked Closed Complete

### **Person 4 — Security Analyst Perspective**

#### *Focus: Access Control and Security*

1. Create three roles: requester, approver, and engineer
2. Use ACLs to control read, create, and write access at the record level
3. Create three groups: Network Requesters, Network Approvers, and Network Team

4. Assign roles to groups, not individual users
5. Enforce record-level security for sensitive requests
6. Add an admin override for urgent changes

## **Person 5 — Communications Lead Perspective**

*Focus: Communication and Notifications*

1. Send a submission confirmation to the requester
2. Send an approval request email to the approver
3. Send an approved or rejected email to the requester
4. Send a completion email when the request is closed
5. Add a feedback survey link in the completion email
6. Support a notification preference center for users

## **Person 6 — Reporting Analyst Perspective**

*Focus: Reporting and Visibility*

1. Create a report for request volume by state
2. Create a report for task performance by team
3. Build a manager dashboard with key metrics
4. Track SLA compliance for approvals
5. Generate monthly reports for management
6. Add a system health dashboard for admins

## **Person 7 — Integration Specialist Perspective**

*Focus: Integration and Data*

1. Integrate with CMDB for device selection
2. Validate device details against CMDB before submission
3. Integrate with change management for firewall changes
4. Add knowledge base articles for common requests
5. Support bulk request submission for multiple devices
6. Add duplicate detection to prevent repeated requests

## **Person 8 — UX Designer Perspective**

*Focus: User Experience and Future Enhancements*

1. Add a “Request Again” button for repeat requests
2. Create a “Favorites” feature for frequently used devices
3. Support a self-service cancellation option
4. Add a request tracking page in the portal
5. Integrate with Virtual Agent for natural language intake
6. Enable mobile-friendly portal access

## **Grouped Ideas (Clusters)**

### **Cluster 1: Form and Catalog Setup**

Catalog item, Standard form with required fields, Dynamic UI Policies, Validation rules, Service Portal, Attachments for supporting documents, Bulk request submission, Duplicate detection

### **Cluster 2: Approval Workflow**

Flow Designer approval workflow, Email notifications to approvers, Multi-level approvals, Reminder emails, Escalation for overdue approvals, Approval history tracking, Admin override for urgent changes

### **Cluster 3: Task Automation**

Auto-create tasks, Auto-assign to Network Team, Task state defaults, Parent-child linking, Wait for task completion, Auto-close requests, Business Rules for default values

### **Cluster 4: Access Control**

Role-based access (requester, approver, engineer), ACLs for read/create/write, User groups, Record-level security, Admin privileges

### **Cluster 5: Reporting and Visibility**

Request volume report, Task performance report, Manager dashboard, SLA compliance tracking, Monthly reports, System health dashboard, Fulfillment time tracking

### **Cluster 6: Integration and Data**

CMDB integration, Change management integration, Knowledge base articles, Virtual Agent integration, Bulk submission, Duplicate detection, Feedback survey integration

### **Cluster 7: Communication and User Experience**

Submission notification, Approval notification, Approved/Rejected notification, Completion notification, Feedback survey, Notification preferences, Request tracking page, Mobile-friendly portal, Request Again button, Favorites feature

### Step 3: Idea Prioritization

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Ideas from the brainstorm were grouped into four quadrants based on importance and feasibility:

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| <p><b>Quadrant 1: High Importance + High Feasibility (DO FIRST)</b></p> <p>Service Catalog item with standard form, Four required variables, Dynamic UI Policies, Flow Designer approval workflow, Auto-create Catalog Task, Auto-assign to Network Team, Auto-close Requested Item, Email notifications (4 types), Role-based access, ACLs, Business Rules for defaults, Update Sets, Groups</p> | <p><b>Quadrant 2: High Importance + Low Feasibility (PLAN)</b></p> <p>CMDB integration, Change management integration, SLA definitions, SLA breach notifications, Manager dashboard, Monthly reports, Multi-level approvals, Escalation for overdue approvals</p> |
| <p><b>Quadrant 3: Low Importance + High Feasibility (QUICK WINS)</b></p> <p>Knowledge base articles, Feedback survey, Priority levels, Request tracking page, Attachments upload, Self-service cancellation, Comments and notes, Favorites feature</p>                                                                                                                                            | <p><b>Quadrant 4: Low Importance + Low Feasibility (SKIP)</b></p> <p>Virtual Agent integration, Natural language intake, Mobile-friendly portal, Admin dashboard, Request templates, Notification preference center, Bulk request submission</p>                  |